

KYLE GAARDER

GTM Leader | New Products | Community & Network Growth

📞 720-232-6836 @ kylegaarder@gmail.com 🔗 linkedin.com/in/kylegaarder 📍 Austin, Texas

SUMMARY

GTM operator and product builder with a track record of 0-1 product launches and community-driven network growth. I build trust-based networks from scratch - designing activation systems, member referral loops, and programs that convert engagement into durable retention. My background spans marketplace GTM, coliving, and market creation. I thrive in ambiguous environments, run rapid experiments across teams, and turn ambitious product bets into scalable real-world growth systems.

For Kindred: I build trust-based networks from scratch — activation systems, referral loops, and community-driven growth that converts engagement into durable retention.

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX

- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
 - Designed onboarding, activation, and community loop systems driving 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
 - Built and tested member referral and ambassador programs - community-led acquisition became primary growth channel
 - Ran 48 community dinners, 4 mastermind cohorts, and 6 work-trade programs, building engagement and retention
 - Executed A/B testing on dynamic pricing and stay-length diversification, generating a 48% annual revenue lift at 94% occupancy
 - Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY. Facilitated smooth acquisition transition to Macro House
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- Built member insights engine via interviews and events, synthesizing patterns into GTM and product recommendations

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR

- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots community outreach and concept validation
- Ran 48 structured customer discovery interviews guiding GTM positioning and go-to-market sequencing
- Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
- Led cross-functional execution across strategy, ops, brand, and product in a pre-launch startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA

- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
- Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
- Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
- Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
- Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



Circles GTM Launch - DRI Ready

Build end-to-end GTM motions for trust-based networks - activation loops, referral programs, community nurture



48% Revenue Lift via Experimentation

A/B tested pricing and engagement programs, drove 48% annual revenue growth at sustained occupancy



Rapid Network Launch

Launched and filled 8-bed network in 2 weeks, sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months



Investor Pilot Secured

Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community network concept across 5 states



Demand Pipeline Built

Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

GTM Strategy & Launch

Community-Led Growth

Cross-Functional Execution

Channel Experimentation

Member Activation Onboarding

Lifecycle & Nurture Programs

Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

Bachelors in Science, Biology

Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014

📍 Virginia, USA

- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA

3.5 / 4.0